

# Nahom Mekonen

[nahomendalk@gmail.com](mailto:nahomendalk@gmail.com) | 404-254-9759 | Minneapolis, MN | [nahommekonen.com](http://nahommekonen.com) | [linkedin.com/in/nahom-e-mekonen](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nahom-e-mekonen)

## PROFILE

Product manager who rose from associate PM to Head of Product over five years, owning the full lifecycle across web and mobile products from discovery to launch to revenue, and technical enough to work directly in SQL, REST APIs, and analytics with engineering. Skilled at turning customer pain points into scalable products in ambiguous, fast moving environments.

## EXPERIENCE

### Kabba Transport

Remote

Early stage mass transit SaaS that connects and coordinates riders, drivers, and operators in real time.

#### Head of Product

Nov 2025 - Present

- Reprioritized the roadmap around trip completion rate, shipping the reliability and driver matching work that cut cancellations and drove the platform past 1M completed trips.
- Manage a team of engineers and contractors, owning hiring, sprint planning, and the quality bar that keeps the rider, driver, and operator apps shipping on a weekly cadence.
- Present the product roadmap and results directly to the executive team, building consensus across engineering, operations, and finance on where to invest next.
- Championed an ERP and government portal integration program that cut manual reconciliation across the operator base by 80%, removing the biggest drag on operator time.

#### Senior Product Manager

Apr 2023 - Nov 2025

- Led product across the rider, driver, and operator apps on web and mobile, scaling the platform to 100+ of the biggest companies in Ethiopia.
- Ran discovery with 100+ operators, drivers, and riders and partnered with a 10 engineer team to take the roadmap from spec through QA and launch.
- Built a SQL backed analytics layer and wrote queries directly to surface the operational metrics that drove pricing, routing, and staffing decisions.
- Launched a configurable B2B corporate tier that grew into a core revenue line, holding client retention at 95% year over year.

#### Product Manager

Feb 2022 - Apr 2023

- Owned the driver and operator apps end to end, running discovery, writing PRDs, A/B testing changes before rollout, and shipping on a weekly release cadence.
- Introduced RICE prioritization to sequence the roadmap and built the discipline to cut work that did not move retention or operational performance.
- Shipped the first payment provider integration, removing a top source of operator support tickets and a chunk of manual reconciliation work.

#### Associate Product Manager

May 2021 - Feb 2022

- Supported senior product and the founding team through the first release, coordinating early operator and rider interviews and writing the first user stories and acceptance criteria.
- Set up early usage tracking and reported weekly adoption numbers to inform what the team built next.

#### Software Engineer Intern

2019 - 2021

#### Wings Transportation

Minneapolis, MN

Regional transportation company running a fleet of around 200 drivers. Two internships early in my career.

- Built internal routing and dispatch software for a 200 driver fleet, cutting manual scheduling work by 40% and getting daily routes out 30% faster.
- Added driver availability and route status tracking, cutting the back and forth calls between dispatchers and drivers by 50%.

## PROJECTS

### LinQ, Student Transportation Management Platform

Routing · GPS Tracking · Dispatch · Parent Mobile App (iOS & Android)

- Built LinQ on my own time to solve a gap I kept seeing in student transportation, a platform for type 3 (seven seater) fleet operators now used by 10+ companies to route 10,000+ students across Minnesota and North Carolina.
- Shipped the routing and dispatch tools, a driver app for district contracted operators, and a parent app for real time student tracking, bringing visibility to a segment the big bus software had ignored.

## SKILLS

|                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Product</b>    | Product strategy and roadmap, 0 to 1 development, discovery and user research, PRDs and user stories, prioritization (RICE), A/B testing, product analytics and north star metrics, go to market |
| <b>Leadership</b> | Cross-functional and executive communication, stakeholder management, team and vendor management, agile and Scrum delivery, SDLC                                                                 |
| <b>Technical</b>  | SQL, Python, REST APIs and integrations, GPS and location data, mobile and web products; domains: mass transit, student transportation, fleet and dispatch, logistics, payments                  |

## EDUCATION

Metro State University, B.S. Computer Science, Dean's List

St. Paul, MN

## LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

**Head of AI Club, Metro State University.** Founded and lead a student organization focused on applied AI.

**Kabba Transport, Africa Startup of the Year Nominee.** Contributed product across the recognized platform.

**Management Leadership for Tomorrow (MLT) Fellow.** Nationally competitive program for high potential leaders.